Indiana State University
CIMT-657
Course Syllabus and Schedule Assignment

Module 7
Due Date:
Point Value: Max. 70 points
(Course Syllabus – 40 points & Course Schedule 30 points)

Learning Objectives

You will

- Establish appropriate timelines for project management. (CO #2)
- Develop meaningful course policies that promote learning and engaging community. (MO)
- Design web-based instruction that incorporates perspectives and needs of diverse groups including universal design and accessibility. (CO #3)
- Sequence and pace your course. (MO)

Directions for Course Syllabus

1. You will be assessed on the thoughtfulness and comprehensiveness of each section description, the creativity and presentation of the formal document, and the quality and depth of the written reflection included separately at the end of the syllabus.
2. Include **at least** the following information in your course syllabus. If you are more comfortable using different headings for your syllabus or arranging the items differently, please do so but be sure to include all of the information requested below so the assignment can be considered for full credit. You can refer to the example posted in this module's resources.
    - **Course introduction:** The teacher's name (you), course title, class period, beginning and ending times, and room number. This may include times when you are available for a conference, and perhaps the school phone number or other contact information.
    - **Course description:** Describe the course, and mention how students will profit from it. This would be similar to a catalog description of the course.
    - **Course learning objectives**: List the content knowledge and skills that you expect students to have when completing this course.
    - **Textbook and course materials**: Mention the textbook, notebook, or other supplies needed by the student.
    - **Instructional approaches and activities:** Indicate the type of instructional approaches (teaching methods or classroom routines) you plan to use during the course, and also mention any special events or activities that may be planned (field trips, experiments, guest speakers, special projects, cooperative groups, etc…).
    - **Course policies**: Include your course policies. Also your policy on late homework or papers, tardiness, absenteeism, extra credit, make-up work, plagiarism, procedures for completing course tasks, and others.
    - **Communication policies:** Include how to communicate with the instructor.

- **Grade and evaluation procedures:** Indicate the means of evaluating student learning: tests, quizzes, homework, projects, group work, work samples, etc. Indicate the point value or relative weight for each of these items when the grade is determined. What is an A? B? C? etc.?
- **A semester outline and timeline of content:** Provide an outline of the content to be covered in the course this semester. This should include some headings to reveal some details about the course, as well as estimates on what content will be covered in each quarter. Consult several resources including the course text for ideas. Specific dates are not necessary but some time frame estimate should be given.

Assessment & Rubric for Course Syllabus (40 points)

Section of Syllabus	**A-level work**	**B-level work**	**C-level work**	**D and F-level work**
General Information				
Course Description				
Course Goals and Expected Outcomes				
Materials Required				
Instructional Approaches and Activities				
Course Requirements and Evaluation Procedures				
Classroom Rules				
Policies on Various Issues				
Semester Content Outline and Timeline				

A-level work: 36-40 points will be awarded for an exceptional description
B-level work: 32-35 points will be awarded for a good description
C-level work: 28-31 point will be awarded for an adequate description with essential elements missing
D and F-level work: 0-27 points will be awarded if section is addressed minimally or not addressed

Directions for Course Schedule

1. After determining the main topics to be covered, the organizational scheme, and an appropriate strategy for accomplishing your objectives, you must create a schedule for the course. It is important to gauge the amount of time necessary for the activities you have in mind, and to map this structure onto the academic calendar. Here are some tips to get you started:
    - Consider the time constraints of your particular course.
    - Spread assignments out to help students manage the workload and to avoid an unrealistic grading burden for yourself.
    - Provide sufficient time between assignments to give students feedback and allow them opportunities to incorporate it.
    - Take into account religious holidays and special events on campus that may affect student work.

- Think about how interruptions (weekends, holidays, etc.) will affect the flow of your course.
- Leave some unscheduled time in your course in case exciting, unanticipated opportunities present themselves or certain topics or activities take longer than expected.

2. Create a grid with 6 columns:
    1) In the first column, write the week of the assessment.
    2) In the second column, write the dates that include the week of the assessments.
    3) Write your topics/focus in the third column.
    4) The instructional strategies and assessments (homework, discussions, group work, etc.) you are considering in the fourth column.
    5) In the fifth column, the materials or resources (readings, films, slides, equipment, etc.) you will need for these instructional strategies and assessments. **See where there are too few or too many activities and add/subtract/reassess as you go.**
    6) In the last column, write the due date for each assignment.
3. You will notice that the instructors who employ these strategies revise and tweak their schedules as they plan until the schedule reflects their objectives for the course, supports the course structure and teaching strategy, sequences work logically, and distributes it realistically across the semester.
4. Creating a good schedule can be time-consuming, but the thought and effort invested at this stage will both help you write your syllabus and prevent problems (e.g., time conflicts, student panic, grading bottle-necks) by helping the course run more smoothly and effectively.

Assessment & Rubric for Course Schedule

A-level work – (27-30 points) - Exceeds Expectations – Evidence of extended mastery of all student outcomes/competencies

- Has included all the necessary components in a course schedule.

B-level work – (24-26 points) - Meets Expectations – Evidence of mastery of all student outcomes/competencies

- Has the necessary components in a course schedule with minor discrepancies or missing information.

C-level work – (21-23 points) - Developing – Evidence of partial mastery of one or more student outcomes/competencies

- Has not included all the necessary components in a course schedule or had to make major changes in a course schedule.

D and F-level work – (0-20 points) - Does Not Meet Expectations – Evidence of limited or incomplete mastery of one or more student; outcomes/competencies or failure to attempt one or more student outcomes/competencies

- Has not included all the necessary components in a course schedule.